

James Wood

23.5 years old
Service Time: 1.091

#29
Bats: Left
Throws: Right

G	AVG/OBP/SLG	HR	RBI	SB	BsR	wRC+	DRS	fWAR
120	.265/.391/.528	30	74	18	1.8	148	-7	3.9

COMBINING ELITE POWER WITH ELITE DISCIPLINE

Wood has been in the spotlight since the Juan Soto trade and has always been a prolific hitter, but has made another jump this year. Wood has increased his BB% from 12.3% to 16.7%, almost doubling MLB’s average, while decreasing his K% from 32.1% → 28.3%. While his K% is still high, Wood can offset that with his high BB%, but could still look to improve. This year Wood’s wOBA/xwOBA increased from .353/.361 to .392/.416. Seeing more pitches and taking walks have helped Wood become one of the most selective hitters in the league.

AN IMPROVED ATTACK ANGLE TO INCREASED BATTED BALL CONTACT



Wood’s pre-pitch barrel and stance position, 2025 vs. 2026

We see Wood has flattened out the angle of his barrel in his pre-pitch setup. In 2026, Wood’s barrel is flatter, possibly to offset his larger frame and higher hand setup. The flatter pre-pitch barrel may have simplified his bat path through the zone, contributing to his ability to barrel the baseball more consistently in 2026 rather than get under it. Wood has increased his sweet spot percentage from the 70th percentile in 2025 to the 87th in 2026, and is centering the ball on all pitch types more frequently. This could also be why Wood has increased his average launch angle from 6.3 degrees in 2025 to 9.3 degrees in 2026.

STANCE AND PLATE POSITION CHANGES

Wood is 2.6 inches closer to the plate in 2026, with his feet 2.8 inches closer together on his setup. Wood’s opposite-field power is well known, and by moving closer to the plate, Wood may improve his ability to use his long arms to his advantage and cover the outer half better. Being able to get his barrel to pitches on the outer half allows him to take advantage of his unique opposite-field power. Wood provides value on the basepaths, using his long legs and strides to move efficiently.

Wood’s power and ability to use all fields give him a high ceiling, but his production could continue to improve if he finds a balance between remaining patient in his approach and being too selective that he takes hittable strikes. Wood has considerably improved every year in nearly every offensive category and, before his oblique injury, was turning into one of the most complete power hitters in the league. Wood does not profile well as an RF due to a below-average range and poor arm value, but his bat and speed on the basepaths make him a unique power-speed combo.